

DAVID BANJO

Penetration Tester | API & Application Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity practitioner focused on penetration testing of web applications and APIs, with hands-on experience assessing authentication, authorization, and business-logic flaws on live and lab platforms. Comfortable reading HTTP traffic end to end (methods, headers, status codes, and response bodies), to pinpoint where an application's real behaviour diverges from its intended logic, and validating every finding by hand rather than trusting scanner output. Strong in the OWASP Top 10 and OWASP API Top 10, JWT attack chains, and manual testing with Burp Suite and Postman. Backed by an enterprise-networking foundation (Cisco Environments) that extends testing beyond the app to the environment around it. Growing focus on the security of AI-built ("vibe-coded") applications. Advancing through the TryHackMe Jr Penetration Tester pathway, with eJPT, CompTIA PenTest+, and OSCP as next targets; while documenting my learnings publicly on Medium.

CORE SKILLS & STACK

- **Testing Tools:** Burp Suite Pro, Postman, wfuzz, ffuf, jwt_tool, Nmap, Kali Linux, Docker
- **Application & API Knowledge:** REST architecture, HTTP methods & status codes, request/response structure, authentication schemes (session, API key, OAuth, JWT), rate limiting, versioning quirks
- **Vulnerability Classes:** OWASP API Top 10 — BOLA, BFLA, Broken Authentication, Excessive Data Exposure, Mass Assignment, Improper Asset Management, SSRF; web flaws — injection, access-control bypass, session-management weaknesses
- **JWT Attacks:** alg:none bypass, RS256→HS256 key confusion, weak-secret brute forcing, claim tampering
- **Networking Foundation:** Routing, switching, Config translations, Cisco Catalyst 9K / ASR 9000, segmentation
- **Also:** Git/GitHub, structured vulnerability reporting and technical write-ups

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security & QA Engineer (Self-Directed) | Treten Networks Limited, Lagos *Mar 2026 – Present*

- Performed web-application and API penetration testing on a full-stack service-management platform (multi-tenant ticketing system, built in-house), covering authentication flows, authorization, JWT handling, and role-based access controls across customer, engineer, and admin portals.
- Identified and helped remediate broken object-level authorization (BOLA), broken function-level authorization (BFLA), and mass-assignment issues in line with the OWASP API Security Top 10, tracing each finding to the responsible code or policy before reporting it.
- Tested login, ticketing, and dashboard interfaces for injection, session-management, and access-control bypass flaws, and extended testing to the live production deployment under authorization.
- Traced data flow across backend–frontend integration points to catch mismatches between expected and actual behaviour, and corrected business-logic errors in SLA calculation, automated status assignment, and ticket escalation.
- Documented defects, security findings, and remediation steps in structured reports supporting ongoing development and future audit requirements.

Network Support Engineer (Intern) | Treten Networks Limited, Lagos *Mar 2026 – Present*

- Supported deployment, configuration, and troubleshooting of enterprise network infrastructure — routers, switches, firewalls, wireless access points, and fibre connectivity — across client environments.
- Worked with Cisco ISE and 802.1X/MAB network access control, contributing to secure onboarding and segmentation within an ISO 27001:2013–certified environment.
- Built an internal knowledge base of exploit methodologies and secure-configuration practices to support future engagements.

Cybersecurity Associate (Intern) | Taxaide Technologies, Lagos *Apr 2024 – Sep 2024*

- Performed penetration testing on web applications and APIs (crAPI, TPay, Capital API, HackTheBox labs), enumerating endpoints and exploiting authorization and business-logic flaws, then documenting remediation guidance.
- Contributed to security assessments and incident-response support within an ISO 27001:2013–certified environment.
- Designed and delivered a company-wide cybersecurity awareness training programme, improving phishing resistance and cyber hygiene.

Security Awareness Analyst (Virtual Experience) | Mastercard, via Forage

Jan 2024

- Simulated an analyst on Mastercard's Security Awareness Team — identifying and reporting phishing threats and proposing targeted training for higher-risk business areas.

SECURITY PROJECTS

Full crAPI Penetration Test | Self-directed / Lab

- Deployed the OWASP crAPI stack via Docker and ran a full assessment across its microservices — mapping endpoints, testing auth flows, and chaining BOLA and mass-assignment issues to escalate access between accounts — using Burp Suite, Postman, and wfuzz, and produced a complete penetration-test report as proof of concept.

JWT Attack-Chain Labs | Self-directed / Kali Linux

- Executed alg:none bypasses and RS256→HS256 key-confusion attacks with jwt_tool, and jwt.io to forge valid tokens without the signing key, and demonstrated weak-secret brute forcing to show impact beyond signature bypass.

Additional API Assessments — TPay, Capital API, VAPI, VAmPI | Self-directed

- Exploited BOLA, broken authentication, and improper asset management across multiple intentionally vulnerable APIs, using the OWASP API Top 10 as the testing framework and producing a write-up for each.

Phishing Email Detection System | Final-Year Project, Covenant University

- Built an NLP/ML pipeline (Logistic Regression, XGBoost) to classify phishing emails, with explainable-AI output so classifications are interpretable rather than a black box.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) — 2024
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate — 2024
- API Penetration Testing Course — APIsec University — 2024, 2026
- Junior Penetration Tester Pathway — TryHackMe (in progress) — 2025
- Complete Ethical Hacking Bootcamp & Web Security / Bug Bounty — Zero to Mastery

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | Covenant University, Ogun State, Nigeria

Sep 2025

Concentrations: Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity. Relevant coursework: Computer Networks, Database Management Systems, Cybersecurity & Information Assurance, Software Engineering.

ADDITIONAL

- I write about lab walkthroughs and API-pentesting on Medium, and maintain a cybersecurity portfolio site of project work and write-ups.
- Founder of an independent perfume brand; former general secretary and public speaker in university and community leadership roles.